

open source community. The current and stable version of Cyanogenmod is 10.2.0.

Paranoid Android

Paranoid Android is another popular custom ROM available for most devices. It has a number of features and customisable options to redefine your device. Paranoid Android was one of the first custom ROMs to get a taste of Android 4.4 via ASOP. It has a unique feature that gives devices a phablet and tablet UI. Its main feature is the HALO and Pie with a unique interface. Hybrid mode helps to set an individual app to acquire a tablet or phablet UI. Installed apps privacy can be viewed and edited. This particular feature lets you control the security of the phone. Floating Mode opens a mini view of a selected app on-screen without navigating from the current screen.

Omni ROM and Kitkat

Omni ROM, also known as the 'Open ROM', is a newly started group that offers customised Android ROMs for most devices. It was started by some senior developers from Paranoid Android. They have released a 4.4 Kitkat custom ROM for over 30 selected devices. It began with Android version 4.4 and it offers support for a universal installer, over-the-air updates, more security features and a user-activated screen recorder. Recently, the group has started releasing nightly builds for some devices, which can be updated via OTA from the device itself. One feature I like about Kitkat is the 'non-intrusive call' that lets an incoming call appear as a pop-up at the bottom of the screen, which I can dismiss or choose to answer. It has all the basic security features, just as in Paranoid Android, and has made a good start with wide support from strong developers.

AOKP

AOKP (Android Open Kang Project) is purely based on AOSP. It cooks ROMs with the source code released by Google. It has a lot of cool features that are unique, like its unicorn logo. LED controls, a ribbon interface, custom toggles, vibration patterns and navigation are some of its cool features. It lets users change the navigation bar size, make it transparent and boot animation. Shortcuts of frequently used apps can be pinned to the navigation bar for easy and quick access. It has a ribbon interface with pinned apps that can be swiped from a particular side. Phablet, tablet and phone mode UIs are available just like with Paranoid Android, which is very useful when the device is in landscape mode. Vibration patterns can be set for each notification so that the user can identify it without looking at the phone. There is a feature called 'Night mode'. Users can change the settings of the phone into night mode with one toggle. It also has some of the other common features available with other ROMs.



Figure 1: CyanogenMod



Figure 2: Paranoid Android



Figure 3: Omni ROM



Figure 4: Aokp ROM



Figure 5: Carbon ROM

Carbon ROM

This is the last ROM in our list and has some cool features compared to the other ROMs mentioned earlier. It is based on the AOSP. It has the Carbon Fibers feature, which packs all custom ROM features in one place, under 'Settings'. You don't have to unlock the device to start the torch app when needed; all you have to do is to 'long press' on the lock screen to turn on the torch. 'Active Display' allows checking of notifications as in Moto X devices. The brightness of the device can be controlled by just sliding across the notification area on the top side of the device, which is way cooler than standard toggle options. It has lots of options such as the 'Option Power' menu, 'Quick launch', a navigation ring, an expandable desktop, LCD density, an apps permission manager, etc. Most of the features listed are the same as Paranoid Android. 

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